PSORIASIS ASSOCIATION OF GHANA & UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI DI MILANO

SCIENTIFIC REPORT: Africa's 1st Psoriasis Genome-Wide Association Study (GWAS)

Cohort Demographics, Clinical Phenotyping, and Genomic Mapping Protocol

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Collaborators: *Psoriasis Association of Ghana (PAG) & University of Milan (Italy) Department of Dermatology and Medical Genetics*

Study Background & Significance

Historically, more than 80% of published autoimmune genome-wide association studies worldwide have been conducted almost entirely on individuals of European ancestry. This acute gap has left dermatologists with limited insights into genetic variants and therapeutic targets relevant to African populations.

Cohort Characteristics

Under the clinical leadership of PAG and the University of Milan, over **3,000 Ghanaian participants** have been enrolled across Greater Accra, Ashanti, and Eastern regions. The study captures phenotypic classifications (plaque, guttate, pustular, erythrodermic), age of onset, family pedigrees, and environmental trigger interactions in West Africa.

Ethical Compliance & Next Steps

All protocols have been thoroughly reviewed and ethically cleared in compliance with Ghana Health Service institutional guidelines and international human genetics standards. Preliminary data analyses are being prepared for submission to international peer-reviewed dermatology congresses through our affiliations with IFPA and GlobalSkin.

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